

Path' checkbox is added to the Canvas section of the Paint Effects Globals. When checked, this causes brushes with tubes whose elevation-Min is greater than 0.5 to be drawn along the path rather than along the normal in canvas mode. Thus, the plant brushes draw in the expected direction when painting in the canvas.

Paint effects and polygons

You can convert Paint Effects strokes to polygonal meshes, including construction history, using **Modify > Convert > Paint Effects To Polygons**.

This allows you to: Render in any renderer, including the Maya Software renderer—mental ray for Maya—the Hardware renderer, and the Vector renderer. Also to have Paint Effects show in reflections, refractions and through transparent objects. Lastly, you can use other polygon-editing tools on them.

Turn on Quad Output, to output to quadrilaterals. The default is off, defaulting output to triangles.

Lights

Intensity and colour curves

Use a custom brightness decay rate to increase a spotlight's brightness, or a custom colour decay rate to change its colour with distance.

Intensity curves and colour curves are graphical representations of a light's brightness and colour with distance. Use the graph editor (**Windows > Animation Editor**), to view them.

The vertical axis represents the intensity or colour intensity value, and the horizontal axis represents distance from the light source. Intensity curves and colour curves are similar to animation curves, except that the horizontal axis of an animation curve represents time.

RampShader brightness

Use this Shader Type to create cartoon-style shading with the help of a ramp with stepped values. The right side of the ramp shows the colour output where the brightness of the diffused and translucent lighting is 1.0 or greater. The left side displays the colour with brightness set to zero.

3D Paint Tool

Edit existing textures

You can now edit both, the size and the file format of existing 3D Paint textures using the Assign/Edit Textures button in the File Textures section of the 3D Paint Tool settings. This button was pre-

viously named Assign Textures and used only for assigning new textures; it had no effect on existing textures.

The displacement attribute

Displacement is added to the Attribute to Paint drop-down list in the File Textures section of the 3D Paint Tool settings. It is now a paintable attribute.

Output

The Maya Vector renderer

Make good use of the Maya Vector to stylise renderings.

It offers cartoon, tonal art, line art, hidden line, wireframe in various bitmap image formats such as IFF, TIFF, etc. It also offers in the following 2D vector formats: Macromedia Flash (non-interactive) version 3, 4 or 5 (SWF), Adobe Illustrator version 8 (AI), Encapsulated PostScript Level 2 (EPS), Scalable Vector Graphics (SVG).



The Maya Vector to render in style!

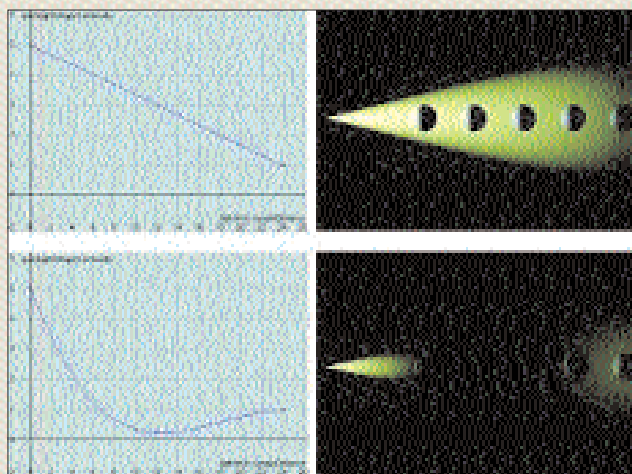
Render layers

These are used to render huge scenes. Below the Channel box, there are display layers. Click on the drop down menu, and change to Render. Add the objects to the layers as you create them.

Now, go to **Windows > Rendering Editor > Render Globals**. Here, in the Maya software Tab, drop down Render Layers/MultiPass Control and turn on the option to Enable Render Layers. All objects are assigned to the default layers. Also, look for transparency throughout the layers at render time.

Fcheck

Access Fcheck by going to **Start > All Programs > Maya > Fcheck**. This utility is provided by Maya to view images and animation sequences. Use it to view high-resolution image sequences. If your RAM doesn't support playback of larger images—because the image sequence is too large—you can shrink it and reduce the image by 50 per cent. Fcheck is also used to re-number the sequence or rename it.



Adjust the brightness of a spotlight to suit your animated needs

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